4.8 Cardiac Dysrhythmias*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My heart is racing and I feel dizzy." • Tires after a few steps **Objective** • Irregular pulse at 140/min (atrial fibrillation) • BP 100/64 mmHg	**ACTUAL** Decreased activity tolerance related to a rapid irregular ventricular rate as evidenced by dizziness, fatigue on minimal exertion and irregular tachycardia.	• Ventricular rate controlled and BP steady within 24 hours.	• Keep her on continuous ECG monitoring. • Count apical and radial pulses at the same time. • Give rate- or rhythm-control drugs as prescribed. • Prepare for cardioversion if ordered. • Follow electrolytes.	• Outcome reached when HR is controlled and BP is stable.
Subjective • "What is wrong with my heart?" **Objective** • Anxious face • Keeps watching the monitor	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety related to irregular heartbeat as evidenced by worry and questioning.	• Reports less anxiety within 24 hours.	• Explain the rhythm and its treatment in simple terms. • Explain what the monitor is for and what the alarms mean. • Invite questions. • Coach slow breathing.	• Considered met when she is calm.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Atrial fibrillation	**RISK** Risk for ineffective cerebral tissue perfusion as evidenced by risk factors: atrial fibrillation with embolic risk.	• No stroke.	• Give anticoagulation as prescribed. • Assess neurological status. • Teach the warning signs of stroke.	• Goal reached if there is no neurological change.

*References for this care plan: [32], [35], [40], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.